

LUCIDPREP

Grade 8 English Language Arts

U.S. Standards-Aligned Course Syllabus

ENGLISH 8

English 8

36 weeks • 4 modules • 70% mastery

Curriculum Architecture

This course is organized as 36 weeks across four 9-week modules. Every week follows LucidPrep's established secondary learning cycle: AI Instructor opening, objectives, vocabulary, five warm-ups, main lecture, two short tutorial videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets, and a 40-question assessment.

Mastery standard: 70%+. Students below mastery review the instructional presentation and may retake the assessment, matching the existing LucidPrep secondary model.

U.S. Alignment Note

English 8 is the standard Grade 8 ELA course. This syllabus uses the Common Core State Standards for ELA/Literacy as the primary reference and cross-checks against major state frameworks. Anchor texts are chosen at the grade-8 complexity band and can be localized.

Prepared for LucidPrep • Curriculum Planning Edition • 2026

Common Instructional & Assessment Model

Weekly Learning Cycle

Step	Component	Description
1	Opening / Domain Overview	~2-minute AI Instructor introduction
2	Objectives + Vocabulary	Student-facing outcomes and core terminology
3	Warm-Up	5 questions with explanations
4	Main Lecture	Concept instruction, models and examples
5	Video Tutorials	2 short instructional videos
6	AI Instructor Presentation	Visual models, examples, strategies and applications
7	Homework	Two sets of 5 questions
8	Weekly Assessment	40 questions; 70% mastery
9	Review / Retake	Below mastery → review presentation → retake

Assessment Philosophy

Assessment is continuous and mastery-based. Each week pairs low-stakes practice (five warm-ups and two homework sets) with a 40-question weekly assessment. Students scoring below 70% review the instructional presentation and retake, so mastery is reached before progressing. Module assessments at Weeks 9, 18 and 27 and a cumulative final at Week 36 measure retention and synthesis.

ENGLISH 8

Grade 8 ELA aligned to the
Common Core State Standards
for Literacy

This 36-week course is designed around **the Common Core Grade 8 strands: Reading Literature (RL.8), Reading Informational Text (RI.8), Writing (W.8), Speaking & Listening (SL.8), and Language (L.8)**. It is a full-year curriculum with four nine-week modules and a consistent LucidPrep mastery workflow.

Grade	Grade 8
Course	English 8
Duration	36 weeks
Structure	4 modules × 9 weeks
Weekly assessment	40 questions
Mastery threshold	70%
Module assessments	Weeks 9, 18, 27
Final assessment	Week 36

Course Learning Outcomes

- Cite the strongest textual evidence and analyze theme and character.
- Analyze text structure, point of view and how authors develop ideas.
- Write arguments, informative texts and narratives with clear reasoning.
- Conduct research and integrate and cite credible evidence.
- Command grammar, usage and vocabulary for effective communication.

Module 1 — Reading Literature & Narrative

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Strongest Textual Evidence	Explicit meaning plus inference; strong support	Cite the strongest textual evidence	RL.8.1
2 — Theme & Objective Summary	Theme development across a text	Analyze theme and summarize objectively	RL.8.2
3 — Dialogue, Incidents & Plot	How dialogue/incidents propel action and reveal character	Analyze how dialogue drives plot	RL.8.3
4 — Word Choice, Analogy & Allusion	Analogies, allusions, tone	Analyze word choice, analogy and allusion	RL.8.4
5 — Comparing Text Structure	Comparing the structures of two texts	Compare and analyze text structure	RL.8.5
6 — Point of View & Irony	Differences in viewpoint; dramatic irony, suspense, humor	Analyze how point of view creates effects	RL.8.6
7 — Narrative Writing	Technique, pacing, reflection, sequencing	Write a refined narrative	W.8.3
8 — Grammar & Conventions	Verbals, active/passive voice, mood, punctuation	Apply grade-8 conventions	L.8.1/2
9 — Module 1 Assessment	Cumulative reading + narrative task	Demonstrate mastery of Module 1	RL.8

Module delivery notes. Read complex literary and informational texts at the grade-8 band. Emphasize analysis of authorial choices and conflicting viewpoints, with sustained writing and evidence use.

Module 2 — Informational Text & Argument

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Central Ideas & Development	Central idea, supporting details, summary	Trace central ideas	RI.8.2
2 — Connections & Distinctions	How a text connects and distinguishes ideas	Analyze connections among ideas	RI.8.3
3 — Structure & Purpose	Paragraph structure; author's purpose and viewpoint	Analyze structure and purpose	RI.8.5/6
4 — Evaluating Arguments	Claims, sound reasoning, sufficient/irrelevant evidence	Delineate and evaluate arguments	RI.8.8
5 — Analyzing Conflicting Information	Two texts with differing interpretations	Analyze conflicting accounts	RI.8.9
6 — Building an Argument	Claim, counterclaim, evidence, organization	Plan a sound argument	W.8.1
7 — Writing the Argument Essay	Drafting, cohesion, formal style	Write an argument essay	W.8.1/4
8 — Revising, Vocabulary & Conventions	Revising; academic vocabulary; editing	Revise and use precise vocabulary	W.8.5; L.8.4/6
9 — Module 2 Assessment	Cumulative informational + argument task	Demonstrate mastery of Module 2	RI.8

Module delivery notes. Read complex literary and informational texts at the grade-8 band. Emphasize analysis of authorial choices and conflicting viewpoints, with sustained writing and evidence use.

Module 3 — Drama, Poetry & Literary Analysis

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Elements of Drama	Modern drama structure and staging	Analyze dramatic elements	RL.8.3/5
2 — Analyzing a Longer Work	Theme and character across a play or novel	Trace theme and character in a long text	RL.8.2/3
3 — Modern Fiction & Traditional Stories	How modern works draw on myths/traditional stories	Analyze use of source material	RL.8.9
4 — Reading Poetry	Form, structure, sound and meaning	Analyze poetic form and sound	RL.8.4/5
5 — Figurative Language & Tone	Metaphor, symbolism, tone, connotation	Interpret figurative language and tone	RL.8.4; L.8.5
6 — Comparing Text & Production	Fidelity of a filmed or staged version	Evaluate adaptation choices	RL.8.7
7 — Literary Analysis Essay	Thesis, textual evidence, analysis	Write a literary analysis	W.8.2/9
8 — Revising & Style	Sentence variety, tone, precise diction	Revise for style and clarity	W.8.5; L.8.3
9 — Module 3 Assessment	Cumulative literary-analysis task	Demonstrate mastery of Module 3	RL.8

Module delivery notes. Read complex literary and informational texts at the grade-8 band. Emphasize analysis of authorial choices and conflicting viewpoints, with sustained writing and evidence use.

Module 4 — Research, Media & Presentation

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Research Questions	Focused questions; generating further questions	Pose and refine research questions	W.8.7
2 — Gathering & Assessing Sources	Credibility, relevance, effective search	Gather and assess sources	W.8.8
3 — Integrating & Citing	Quote/paraphrase, avoid plagiarism, citation	Integrate and cite sources	W.8.8
4 — Synthesizing Sources	Combining evidence and drawing conclusions	Synthesize multiple sources	W.8.7/9
5 — Research Writing	Thesis, structure, evidence, drafting	Draft a research-based paper	W.8.2/7
6 — Analyzing Media & Digital Texts	Purpose, motives, mediums	Evaluate media and digital texts	RI.8.7; SL.8.2
7 — Presentation & Multimedia	Presenting findings; integrating multimedia	Present claims with multimedia	SL.8.4/5
8 — Discussion & Language Review	Collaborative discussion; cumulative conventions	Discuss effectively and command language	SL.8.1; L.8.1-6
9 — Final Assessment	Cumulative final across all modules	Demonstrate mastery of the full course	RL/RI/W/SL/L.8

Module delivery notes. Read complex literary and informational texts at the grade-8 band. Emphasize analysis of authorial choices and conflicting viewpoints, with sustained writing and evidence use.

Assessment & Alignment

Assessment Blueprint

Warm-ups: weekly • Homework: weekly • Weekly assessment: 40 questions • Module assessments: Weeks 9 / 18 / 27 • Final: Week 36 • Below 70%: instructional review and retake.

Standards Alignment

Primary framework	CCSS ELA-Literacy Grade 8: RL, RI, W, SL, L
Literacy Practices	Close reading and citing evidence; analyzing craft and structure; building and evaluating arguments; conducting research; writing across text types; collaborative discussion; command of conventions.
Recurring Concepts	Evidence and reasoning; author's craft; multiple perspectives; the writing process; academic vocabulary.
State mapping	Common Core ELA adopted by most states; Texas TEKS and other frameworks cover the same grade-band strands under different codes.

Content Production Guidance

Author each week around anchor texts at the grade band: 5 warm-ups (vocabulary / close reading), a craft-focused lecture, 2 videos, an AI presentation modeling analysis and writing, 2 homework sets, and a 40-question bank blending reading comprehension, language and constructed response. Tag items to standards.

Curriculum Basis & Source Notes

This Grade 8 English Language Arts syllabus was generated from the Common Core State Standards for ELA/Literacy. Content reflects the standard English 8 course, with anchor texts selected at the grade-appropriate complexity band.

Primary reference	Common Core State Standards for ELA/Literacy — grade 8 strands (Reading Literature, Reading Informational, Writing, Speaking & Listening, Language).
State cross-check	California and New York State ELA / literacy frameworks.
State cross-check	Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS) for English Language Arts and Reading.
LucidPrep alignment	Mapped to LucidPrep's 36-week structure; module anchor-text lists to be finalized locally.

Recommended next production step. Select the anchor text set (novels, drama, poetry, nonfiction) for each module at the grade band, then commission tagged item banks and writing rubrics per week.